

PURPOSE: To improve the chances of attaining “O” plan by modifying the eligibility criteria for grades.

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BE IT RESOLVED BY THE MISSISSIPPI SCHOOL FOR MATHEMATICS AND SCIENCE

SECTION ONE (DEFINITIONS)

“O” Plan: The highest tier privilege plan offered to students in their senior year at MSMS. For eligibility criteria and privileges please refer to page 113 of the Student Handbook.

Percentage Average: The sum of grades for every course taken by a student divided by the quantity of grades totaled.

SECTION TWO (REASONING):

The privilege plan system at MSMS is developed in order to recognize the differences in students’ abilities to exercise sound judgement, make good decisions, and generally act maturely. Privilege plan selection is based on an individual student's grades, behavior, work service, wellness, attendance, and participation in school organization.

The nature of MSMS privilege plans is not meant to categorize students based on the selection criteria; rather, it is intended to incentive positive characteristics within students in Goen and Frazer Hall. The positive characteristics are defined by the eligibility criteria listed on page 113.

Students have expressed their desire to specifically modify the eligibility criteria for grades for this privilege plan. By reducing the minimum percentage average from 93 to 90, students will be more motivated to satisfy the eligibility criteria. In doing so, more students will exhibit better behavior.

Another justification for this modification is to further publicize the requirements and encourage more students to pursue the “O” Plan thereby improving overall dorm etiquette and academic performance.

It can be argued that relaxing the average constraint may be an example of lowering expectations. However, it should be noted that the purpose of the privilege plan is not merely to reward high grades. Instead, it is the culmination of good behavior, appropriate stewardship, and community participation. (Refer to page 110 under section Philosophy) Students on track for “O” Plan selection should not be punished for earning only “A”s and “B”s given that “C” disqualify the student (Refer to page 113 of Student Handbook).

It is for all the reasons outlined prior that the eligibility criteria regarding percentage average for seniors to attain “O” Plan shall be modified from 93-100 to 90-100.

SECTION THREE (SPECIFIC CHANGE):

On page 113 of the Student Handbook (PDF page 118) under the segment “THE “O” PLAN” within the column “ELIGIBILITY CRITERIA” beside cell “GRADES” corresponding to bullet point “Percentage Average:”

THE "O" PLAN

(Only offered to seniors)

ELIGIBILITY CRITERIA		PRIVILEGES	
GRADES	- Percentage Average: 93-90–100 or All A's - No NCs and no C's	LIGHTS OUT	Regular
VIOLATIONS	- No more than two Level I written warnings - No Level II or III	CURFEW	Regular
SATURDAY SCHOOL	No more than 1 hr assigned for academic reasons	STUDY HOURS	3 days a week not required (remember that others will be studying)
EXTRA-CURRICULAR	Participation/Membership in 2 activities, clubs, sports, or organizations during the previous 9 weeks	TV TIME	- Ends 12:00 a.m. Sunday – Thursday - Study hours – on nights not required
ATTENDANCE	- No unexcused absences - No more than two tardies during the nine-week period	SIGN OUT LIMIT (weekend)	7 hours
WORK SERVICE	Outstanding rating	CAR USE	- Monday – Thursday for general errands [4 hours; local; in by 10:00] 5 general purpose sign-outs [4 hours; local; in by 10 p.m.] 3 special event sign-outs [48 hours prior permission from the Hall Director]
RESIDENTIAL LIVING	Outstanding rating		
WELLNESS	Outstanding rating		